

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♥3

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠3

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥Q

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 1NT

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣Q

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 7 4 2

♥ Q 8 2

♦ 7 4

♣ Q J 3

♠ A 10 6

♥ A 7 4

♦ K Q 10 2

♣ K 8 4



♠ Q 9

♥ J 10 5 3

♦ J 9 5

♣ A 10 7 2

♠ 8 5 3

♥ K 9 6

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 9 6 5

West

Pass

All Pass

1NT by North

Lead: ♥3

North

1NT

*East**South*

NORTH has a perfect 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

SOUTH has 7 points; he knows that the most points the partnership could hold is 24 (7 + 17). Since this is below the 26 point game requirement he passes.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 7
♥ A 9 6
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ K 8 4

♠ K J 6 5

♥ 7 5 3

♦ A 6

♣ 10 7 3 2



♠ A Q 4
♥ K 10 8
♦ J 10 9 5
♣ A Q 6

♠ 8 3 2

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ 8 4 2

♣ J 9 5

EAST has an ideal 1NT opening - 16 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, WEST knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game but not enough to think about slam. Since WEST also has a balanced hand she bids 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♠ 3

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 5
♥ Q J 10 5 3
♦ 8 2
♣ J 8 4 3

♠ A J 3
♥ A 8 7
♦ Q J 10 5
♣ Q 10 7



♠ 10 9 6 4
♥ 4 2
♦ K 7 6 3
♣ K 9 2

♠ K Q 8 2
♥ K 9 6
♦ A 9 4
♣ A 6 5

SOUTH has 16 points and balanced distribution. She naturally opens 1NT.

NORTH has 14 points and balanced distribution so he does the math. The partnership has at least 29 points (14 + 15). The partnership has at most 31 points (14 + 17).

Since this is more than the 26 needed for game, but fewer than the 33 needed for slam NORTH just bids 3NT, knowing SOUTH will respect his decision and pass.

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥Q			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 9 6
♥ A J 5
♦ A Q J
♣ A 9 3 2

♠ 10 4 3
♥ K 10 9 6 3
♦ K 10
♣ Q J 10

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 5 2
♥ 8 7 2
♦ 9 4 3
♣ 7 6 5

♠ Q 8 7
♥ Q 4
♦ 8 7 6 5 2
♣ K 8 4

When WEST opens 1NT, EAST knows that he cannot have more than 17 points. So with her 7 points, she knows there is no reason to respond.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

All Pass

1NT by West

Lead: ♣Q